



1618

THE DEFENESTRATION OF PRAGUE

The event that precipitated the ruinous Thirty Years' War in Europe occurred in Prague, then capital of Bohemia, in May 1618. Bohemia's largely Protestant people were at odds with their Catholic King Ferdinand, backed by Holy Roman Emperor Matthias. During a confrontation with Bohemian leaders in Hradčany Castle, two Catholic Regents sent by the emperor were thrown out of a high window. Both survived, but this act of Protestant defiance triggered a religious war.

◁ *Defenestration of Prague*, Václav Brožík, 1890

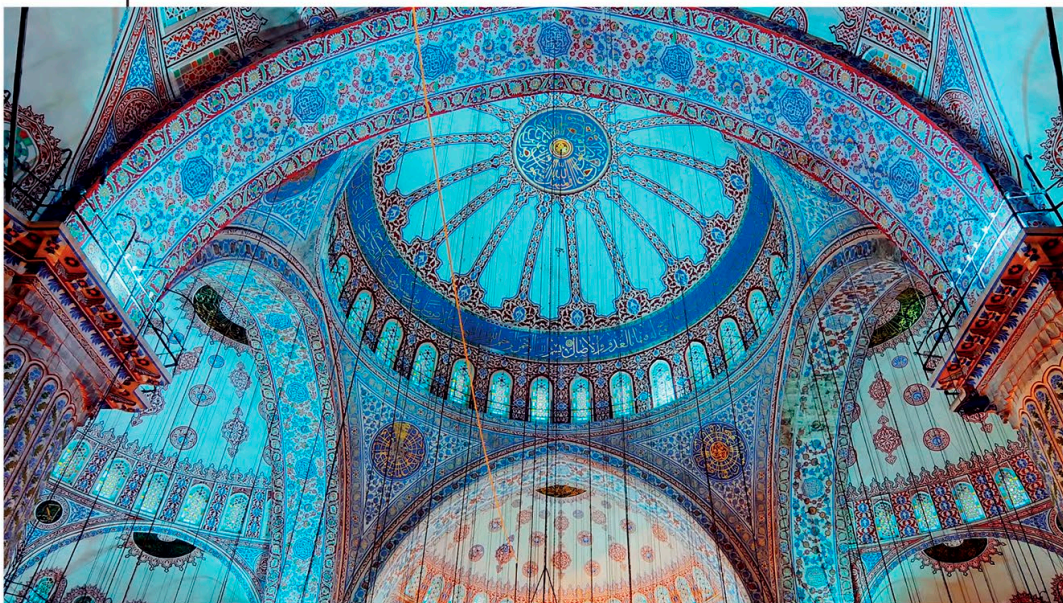
1619 German astronomer Johannes Kepler

mathematically describes the movement of the planets

1619 The Dutch conquer

Jakarta and impose their rule on parts of Indonesia through massacre

1619



1616

BLUE MOSQUE

When it was completed in 1616, the magnificent Sultan Ahmet Mosque – known as the Blue Mosque for the colour of its tiled interior – dominated the skyline of the Ottoman capital, Istanbul, with its six slender minarets. Commissioned by Ahmet I, sultan from 1603 to 1617, the mosque was a confident assertion of the continuing power and prestige of the Ottoman Empire.

◁ *Blue mosque ceiling*

The ceiling of the Ottoman Sultan Ahmet Mosque consists of 20,000 ceramic tiles